



TWO INDUS CORRIDORS?

Researchers propose that the Rann may once have been connected to the Indus through two river–maritime corridors

KNOWN ROUTE

- The Nara-Puran, a major branch of the Indus, flowed through the Rann to Kori Creek
- Sindri, Vigakot, Kanjarkot and Rahim ka Bazaar were fortified sites along this historic corridor
- The 1819 earthquake blocked the Nara, submerged Sindri Fort
- Sayra, the greenish patch east of this river, was a fertile district till late 1700s

PROPOSED CORRIDOR

- Barbadgaon's rice hullers point to a rice-processing landscape 5-7 centuries before Sayra's documented rice-growing phase
- Researchers propose that the Garah, a second distributary of the lower Indus, once flowed west towards Sir Creek, providing an independent waterway to the sea
- Later, the Indus moved further west to adopt its modern course

WHY IT MATTERS

- **Only two sites, Karim Shahi and Vigakot,** have been excavated and scientifically dated in the western Great Rann. Vigakot's occupation ended around 1050 CE; it is next documented as a customs post in the 1700s
- **Barbadgaon fills that gap,** says Ajay Yadav of the University of Oxford's School of Archaeology. Its Soomra-period pottery provides physical evidence of the medieval Sindh-Kutch connection, so far known from historical accounts of the Soomra rule in Sindh
- **Nearby Harappan sites in Pakistan**—Karahyo Pir, Koonjsor, Markhan and Kot Khori—show that the wider landscape was inhabited thousands of years earlier

WHAT NOW

The site has yet to be absolutely dated or systematically excavated; its original name remains unconfirmed, and it has no formal protection status

SURVEY
Archaeological survey of Barbadgaon and the wider frontier landscape

EXCAVATE
Controlled excavation to establish the site's chronology and its settlement pattern

TRACE THE RIVER
Geophysical survey and palaeochannel mapping to test the proposed Garah route

DATE AND RECONSTRUCT
Sediment, ceramic and slag analysis, scientific dating and environmental reconstruction

CONSERVE
Plan for an integrated conservation of archaeology, geoheritage, ecology and the wider frontier landscape